

Redefining Rigor for the 21st Century: Seven Survival Skills

Identify the skills these employers value in prospective employees.

"Yesterday's answers won't solve tomorrow's problems."	1. Critical Thinking and Problem Solving
"Technology has allowed for virtual teams. We have teams working on major infrastructure projects that are all over the U.S. On other projects, you're working with people all around the world on solving a software problem. Every week they're on a variety of conference calls; they're doing Web casts; they're doing net meetings."	2. Collaboration and Leadership
"I can guarantee the job I hire someone to do will change or may not exist in the future, so this is why adaptability and learning skills are more important than technical skills."	3. Agility and Adaptability
"I say to my employees, if you try five things and get all five of them right, you may be failing. If you try 10 things, and get eight of them right, you're a hero. You'll never be blamed for failing to reach a stretch goal, but you will be blamed for not trying."	4. Initiative and Entrepreneurialism
"[Young people] have difficulty being clear and concise; it's hard for them to create focus, energy, and passion around the points they want to make."	5. Effective Oral and Written Communication
"There is so much information available that it is almost too much, and if people aren't prepared to process the information effectively it almost freezes them in their steps."	6. Access and Analyzing Information
"For businesses it's no longer enough to create a product that's reasonably priced and adequately functional. It must also be beautiful, unique, and meaningful."	7. Curiosity and Imagination

(Wagner 2008)